

deal of help on the problems associated with the statistics of large deviations. Michael Allen wrote a monograph for writers looking to get published, based on the ideas of [Chapter 8](#)—I subsequently rewrote [Chapter 8](#) through the eyes of a writer looking at his lot in life. Mark Blyth was always helpful as a sounding board, reader, and adviser. My friends at the DoD, Andy Marshall and Andrew Mays, supplied me with ideas and questions. Paul Solman, a voracious mind, went through the manuscript with severe scrutiny. I owe the term *Extremistan* to Chris Anderson, who found my earlier designation too bookish. Nigel Harvey guided me through the literature on forecasting.

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